nature mild, kind, liberal and good-tempered', his entourage of youthful retainers 'had corrupted him', and so 'his sole pleasure was in the chase, in love-making and in running hither and thither'.

At the Mughal court, meanwhile, the situation remained turbulent and precarious between the two remaining princes. It was at this time that Daniyal was caught up one night in a most mysterious ruckus. Abu'l Fazl writes about an incident in which due to 'some carelessness on the part of the sentinels', an intruder managed to infiltrate into the royal harem. Daniyal saw a 'madman', threw him to the ground and tussled with the man, creating a huge uproar which attracted all the female guards, the 'Circassians, Qalmaqs, Russians and Abyssinians'. Akbar himself rushed upon the men and 'thinking that the prince was a stranger', seized him by the hair and was about to kill him with his sword when he realized that it was his own son. The intruder was judged to be a lunatic, and allowed to leave. This incident leaves many questions unanswered, primarily because of the near impossibility of a 'lunatic' being able to stumble upon the closely guarded imperial harem. Fifty men carrying torches were assigned simply to patrol the riverbank, day and night, to ensure no intruder could scale the fort walls to enter the palace. Moreover, if Daniyal had been in the harem officially, there would have been no reason for the guards not to recognize him, and immediately assault him as a stranger, nor for his father to attack him. Almost immediately following this incident, Daniyal's marriage was arranged with the daughter of the powerful courtier, Qulij Khan, and he was then dispatched to deal with the insufficiently submissive Burhan Shah.

This incident, during which it would appear that Daniyal had slipped into the royal harem unannounced, may lie at the heart of the famous Anarkali myth. The first mention of this possibly fictitious but enormously popular Anarkali was by the English traveller, William Finch, who came to Lahore in 1608. He claimed that Anarkali was the mother of Daniyal, and that Salim had had an improper relationship with her, causing Akbar to have her walled up alive in a fit of jealousy. The heartbroken Salim, when he became Padshah Jahangir, continued the story, would then have a tomb built for Anarkali in Lahore. There were, however, no further accounts of this story either in the Persian histories, or by foreign travellers over the next 200 years, nor indeed by Jahangir himself in his remarkably frank memoir.